

Ricardo de Nóbrega Pearce

PERSONAL INFO

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+27-82-327-0797

Portuguese (EU) citizen · Relocating to the Netherlands · Full EU work rights, no sponsorship required.

Nationality:

Language Skills:

South African / Portuguese

English (Native)

Afrikaans (Basic)

Dutch (learning A1)

SUMMARY

Core Network and Security Engineer with 7+ years designing, operating, and securing carrier and enterprise grade infrastructure across ISP, managed services, and large scale IoT environments. Deep hands on expertise with Juniper (MX, MPLS, BGP), Fortinet, and Cisco, spanning routing, switching, network security, and high availability design, backed by Python and Ansible automation.

Portuguese (EU) citizen relocating permanently to the Netherlands, with full EU work rights and no sponsorship required. Currently responsible for the stability, security, and performance of a South African ISP's core network, acting as a senior escalation point for complex incidents and driving automation and standardisation initiatives, including a Python solution that deployed 2,000+ FortiGate DNAT policies.

Seeking a senior network engineering role to commit to long term in the Netherlands.

Certifications

Completed:

- Cisco CCNP Enterprise (ENCOR)
- Juniper JNCIP-SP
- Juniper JNCIS-ENT
- Fortinet FCA

Currently pursuing:

- CCIE Enterprise Infrastructure (Lab Preparation)

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Company: **Saicom**, Johannesburg (South Africa)
Date: March 2026 to present
Industry: Telecommunications / Networking / Security / Infrastructure
Role: Core Network and Security Engineer

DESCRIPTION:

A South African national ISP and telecommunications provider; responsible for the stability, security, and performance of the core network.

RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Lead core network operations for a national ISP running Juniper MX (MPLS/BGP) and FortiGate, serving as a senior escalation point for complex routing, switching, and security incidents.
- Remediated a persistent WiFi performance failure across 12 FortiAP units at a corporate site, cutting packet loss from ~28% to negligible through DARRP tuning and reducing channel width to 20 MHz.
- Launched a NetBox source-of-truth initiative, auditing IP drift across 8 core devices in three regions and reconciling ~490 live addresses absent from records, establishing device configs as ground truth.
- Diagnosed and resolved a core QoS misclassification where NETWORK-CONTROL traffic was marked cs7 instead of cs5 in the BA classifier, restoring correct control-plane prioritisation.
- Resolved recurring path-MTU black-holing on an inter-site SSH path via TCP MSS clamping on FortiGate, and traced a BGP instability event to an upstream interface change.
- Drive automation and standardisation using Python and Ansible, reducing manual configuration effort and improving consistency across the core.

Company: **Cartrack**, Johannesburg (South Africa)
Date: August 2025 to March 2026
Industry: Fleet and vehicle tracking / Telematics
Role: Network and Security Engineer

DESCRIPTION:

A global leader in vehicle telematics and large scale IoT, supporting millions of connected devices across business critical services.

RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Built a Python automation solution that deployed 2,000+ FortiGate destination-NAT policies, compressing a two-week manual deployment into a single day while eliminating configuration drift across the estate.
- Operated a high-availability global network spanning ~5 data centres and ~50 sites, personally overseeing the Africa and Asia regions and supporting real-time telematics for millions of connected IoT devices.
- Designed and secured routing, switching, firewall, APN, and VPN services across global WAN and large-scale IoT environments.
- Built GitLab-based automation workflows for proactive fault detection, improving operational visibility across the estate.

Company: **Three6five**, Midrand (South Africa)
Date: June 2022 to July 2025
Industry: Multiple service provider
Role: Network Engineer

DESCRIPTION:

A managed service provider delivering WAN, LAN, security, and network solutions to enterprise clients across South Africa and internationally.

RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Led one of two enterprise engineering teams, owning network delivery for ~40 enterprise customers (roughly half the company's enterprise base) across South African and international sites.
- Supported and optimised multi client environments across Cisco, Juniper, and Fortinet, spanning MPLS, VPN, routing, switching, and security.
- Led network audit engagements for enterprise customers, assessing infrastructure against best practice, identifying gaps, and delivering remediation recommendations.
- Implemented Python and Ansible automation and onboarded new customer environments into the NMS, improving network visibility and service consistency.
- Supported and optimised the national network for City Lodge Hotel Group, one of southern Africa's largest hotel chains (50+ properties), ensuring reliable connectivity across geographically distributed sites.
- Deployed and commissioned a new Point of Presence (PoP) in Lusaka, Zambia.
- Conducted a wireless site survey and optimisation across a nine floor hospitality site in London.

Company: **Zavux** , Springs (South Africa)

Date: May 2020 to April 2022
Industry: Cryptocurrency
Role: Infrastructure and Network Engineer

- Built Python automation and managed server infrastructure and API integrations for a cryptocurrency exchange, supporting its growth to R10 million monthly turnover.

Company: Security Audit and Control solutions
Date: September 2019 to April 2020
Industry: CyberSecurity
Role: Junior Security Engineer

- *Supported penetration testing, security assessments, and SOC design and monitoring for enterprise and government clients.*

Company: Three6five, Midrand (South Africa)
Date: December 2018 to August 2019
Industry: Multiple service provider
Role: Field engineer

- Onsite deployment, troubleshooting, and support of enterprise network infrastructure across customer sites.